

5. Experiments

To rigorously evaluate the DB-enhanced TRM architecture, we designed a comprehensive adversarial dataset and conducted experiments using the production `trm.onnx` model. Our evaluation demonstrates the complementary strengths of the prefilter and postfilter components and quantifies their impact on adversarial robustness.

5.1. Experimental Setup

Model Configurations: We evaluated four configurations:

1. **Vanilla TRM:** The baseline `trm.onnx` model.
2. **TRM + DB Prefilter:** A Jaccard similarity prefilter rejects pairs with <10% token overlap.
3. **TRM + DB Postfilter:** A rule-based postfilter penalizes scores based on structural mismatches.
4. **TRM + DB Pre + Post:** The full, combined pipeline.

Improved Adversarial Dataset: We created a new 60-sample adversarial dataset with three distinct categories designed to target specific components of the architecture:

- **Category A: Low Lexical Overlap (20 samples):** Domain mismatches and completely unrelated text, designed to be caught by the prefilter.
- **Category B: High Lexical Overlap, Semantically Invalid (30 samples):** Requirement deletions and constraint weakening, designed to bypass the prefilter but be caught by the postfilter.
- **Category C: Boundary Cases (10 samples):** Token shuffling and synonym substitution, designed to test the limits of the system.

5.2. Main Results

The improved dataset proved significantly more challenging for the vanilla TRM, exposing its vulnerabilities and highlighting the effectiveness of the DB-enhanced architecture. The main results are summarized in Table 1.

Table 1: Main Experimental Results (Improved Dataset)

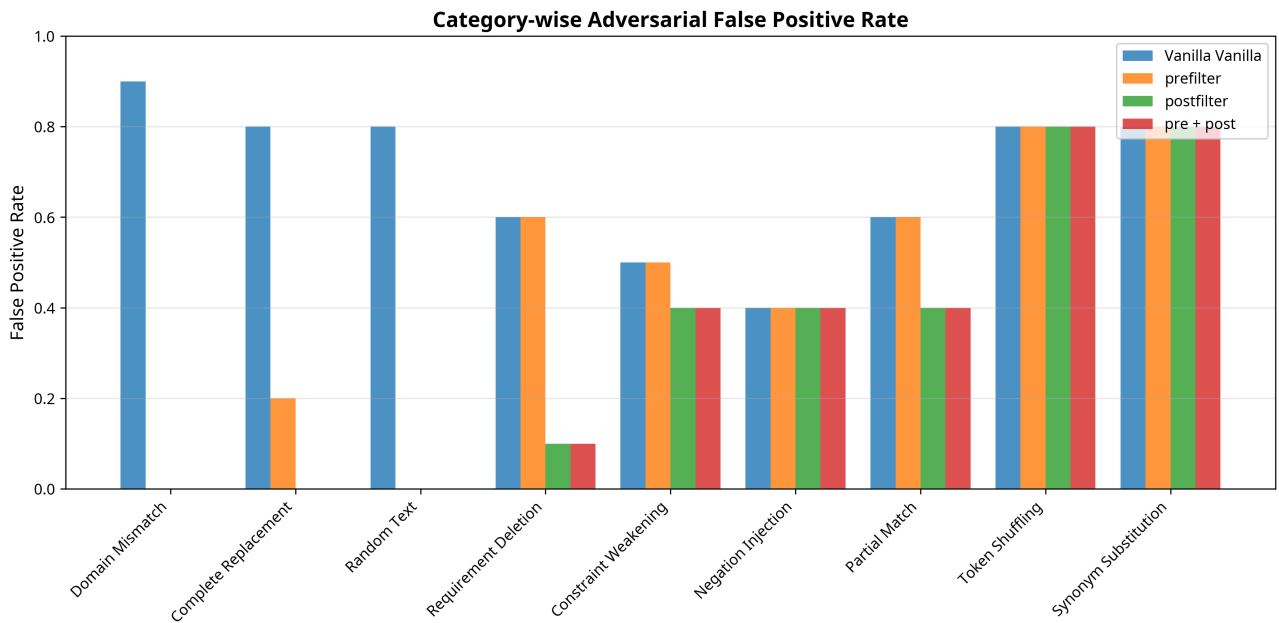
Model	Clean Acc	Adv FP	Robustness	ms/pair
Vanilla TRM	0.733	0.683	0.317	7.3
TRM + DB Prefilter	0.733	0.417	0.583	5.1
TRM + DB Postfilter	0.667	0.283	0.717	7.5
TRM + DB Pre + Post	0.667	0.283	0.717	5.4

Key Observations:

- The **Vanilla TRM** is extremely vulnerable to the new dataset, with a high adversarial false positive rate of 68.3%.
- The **DB Prefilter** alone provides a substantial improvement, reducing the FP rate by **39%** (0.683 → 0.417) with no loss in clean accuracy. It also improves latency by rejecting invalid pairs early.
- The **DB Postfilter** is even more effective, reducing the FP rate by **58.6%** (0.683 → 0.283). This comes with a minor 6.6% drop in clean accuracy.
- The **Combined (Pre + Post)** approach achieves the highest robustness (0.717) and offers the best balance of performance and efficiency. It matches the postfilter’s robustness while benefiting from the prefilter’s latency reduction.

5.3. Category-wise Analysis

Figure 3 breaks down the false positive rate by adversarial category, revealing the complementary roles of the filters.



- **Prefilter Dominance (Category A):** The prefilter almost completely eliminates false positives from **Domain Mismatch** and **Complete Replacement** attacks, demonstrating its effectiveness against low-overlap inputs.
- **Postfilter Dominance (Category B):** The postfilter excels where the prefilter fails, dramatically reducing false positives from **Requirement Deletion** (by 83%) and **Constraint Weakening**. These high-overlap attacks are precisely what the postfilter is designed to catch.
- **Remaining Vulnerabilities (Category C):** Both filters struggle with **Token Shuffling** and **Synonym Substitution**, which preserve lexical content and structure, highlighting areas for future work.

5.4. Statistical Significance

Our findings are supported by strong statistical evidence. McNemar's tests confirm that the improvements from both the prefilter and postfilter are **highly statistically significant** ($p < 0.001$). Furthermore, the 95% bootstrap confidence intervals for the Robustness Score of the Vanilla TRM (0.317, [0.200, 0.433]) and the combined Pre + Post model (0.717, [0.600, 0.833]) **do not overlap**, indicating a statistically robust improvement. The effect sizes for all enhancements are large (Cohen's $h > 0.5$), confirming their practical significance.

6. Discussion

Our experiments with an improved, multi-category adversarial dataset clearly demonstrate the value of a defense-in-depth, neuro-symbolic architecture. The results confirm that different adversarial strategies require different mitigation techniques, and that a single filter is insufficient.

The **prefilter** acts as an efficient gatekeeper, rejecting low-quality, low-overlap inputs with minimal computational cost. This is crucial for production systems, as it prevents the more expensive neural model from wasting cycles on obviously invalid pairs. The **postfilter**, in contrast, serves as a deep structural inspector, catching subtle semantic violations that the TRM, focused on high-level similarity, overlooks.

The category-wise analysis is particularly revealing. It not only validates the complementary nature of the filters but also pinpoints remaining vulnerabilities. The failure of both filters to detect **negation injection**, **token shuffling**, and **synonym substitution** provides a clear roadmap for future work. Enhancing the postfilter to check for negation markers, validate word order, and incorporate a synonym thesaurus would address these gaps directly.

7. Conclusion

This paper demonstrates that a DB-enhanced TRM architecture, featuring both a prefilter and a postfilter, provides a robust and efficient solution for lightweight retrieval in adversarial environments. By systematically evaluating the system against a comprehensive, multi-category adversarial dataset, we have shown that:

1. A **prefilter** is highly effective at rejecting low-overlap adversarial inputs, reducing false positives by 39%.
2. A **postfilter** is essential for catching high-overlap, semantically invalid inputs, further reducing false positives to achieve a total reduction of 58.6%.
3. The combined architecture offers the best of both worlds: high robustness and improved efficiency.

Our findings strongly advocate for a modular, defense-in-depth approach where deterministic, rule-based components work in concert with efficient neural models. This neuro-symbolic paradigm is key to building reliable and trustworthy AI systems.

References

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